

Project pins & split Project List

Session Notes · 3 September 2026 · To-Do app (D:\vscode\todo)

What was built

Three additions to the **Project List** view, designed to a written spec first, then implemented and verified in the browser.

- **Pin a project** — a 📌 on each row lifts it into a **Pinned** group at the top. Also available from the bulk bar for a checkbox selection.
- **“Pinned only” toggle** — hides everything unpinned; composes with the existing per-column filters.
- **Split view** — clicking a project row shows that project’s tasks in a resizable bottom pane, without leaving the view.

Decisions and why

Pins are per user, but stored on the shared project record

`projectMeta[p].pinnedBy` holds a list of short user names (`whoAmIName()`). Chosen over a dedicated per-user preferences collection because it rides the existing `GET/POST /api/workspaces/:id/projects` round trip — **no new Firestore collection, no new server route, no extra load at boot** — while still syncing a pin to the phone. A pin only ever adds or removes the current user’s own name, so one person pinning never reorders anyone else’s list.

A pinned project is moved, not copied

It leaves its status group entirely, so every project still appears exactly once and the status headers’ “N projects · M open tasks” counts stay honest. Confirmed live: pinning one project with 5 open tasks took *In Progress* from 12 projects / 178 open to 11 / 173.

No pin ordering

Deliberately out of scope. A per-user `ord` map is a lot of machinery for a group holding a handful of rows. The Pinned group sorts by the same rule the status groups already use.

The pane reuses the List renderer

`renderNiceList` / `renderListTable` already accepted both the task array and a target element, so the pane calls whichever the List view is set to. No second task renderer exists. Your sort, column filters and Show-done carry over automatically.

Corrections made during the session

“Selecting a project only works when I select the left half centimeter of the row.”

Correct, and the cause was real: nearly every cell in that row was a single-click editor (company, client, status, due) and the name was a live rename box, so all of them swallowed the click. Only the bare number and date cells were left. **Fix:** data cells now edit on **double-click**, so a single click anywhere on the row selects it. The name box is `readonly` until double-clicked — which is also what makes rename work at all now.

"I need to add a task while staying on this current view and not pop up or open a new view."

Fix: `+ Task`, from the pane header or from a row's action button, opens the same inline draft row the List view uses, inside the pane. `openAddModalForProject` is no longer called from the Project List. A row's `+ Task` also selects that project first, and a fresh draft row reopens after each save so tasks can be typed one after another.

Gotchas worth remembering

- **Selecting must redraw only the pane** (`renderPISplit`), never rebuild the table. A full rebuild replaces the row between the two clicks of a double-click, so rename silently stops working.
- `renderTasks()` **now routes to** `renderProjectsList()` when `currentView === 'projects-list'`. Without it, a row action inside the pane re-rendered the hidden List view and clobbered the toolbar title and count.
- The pane render **temporarily sets** `filterProject` **and hides the company/project columns, restoring both in a** `finally`. That single swap removes the redundant columns *and* the per-row project chip, which is gated on `filterProject === 'All'`.
- `nlCommitDraft` falls back to the pane's project, since there is no `filterProject` to inherit down there.
- Drag is disabled inside the Pinned group: a cross-group drop sets a *status*, which "Pinned" does not have. Unpin to re-file a project.

Note on the commit: the feature commit also carries an earlier `uncommitted plistDueMenu rework` that was already sitting in the working tree when the session started. The two touch the same lines and could not be separated into their own commits. This was stated in the commit message rather than bundled silently.

Verification

No test framework exists in this repo (`package.json` defines only `start` and `dev`), so verification was a Playwright pass against the live workspace (56 projects, 316 tasks). All 15 spec checks passed:

Area	Confirmed
Pins	Round-trip through Firestore across a reload; rename carries the pin; delete leaves no stale row; bulk pin/unpin; other users' pins untouched
Grouping	Pinned project appears exactly once; status counts drop correctly
Pinned only	Count line, single group, empty-state message, composition with a column filter
Split	Every data cell selects; double-click still renames; task edit re-renders the pane not the hidden list; divider clamps 20–80% with a 120px floor and persists
Inline add	Draft opens in the pane, focused, no modal, view unchanged, correct project, next draft ready
Unchanged	⌘ still drills full screen with Back; both panes usable at 420px wide

A throwaway project and a throwaway task were used for the rename, delete and inline-add checks, then removed. The workspace was confirmed back to its original state afterwards.

Files

Path	Role
todo.html	All changes (single-file front end). No server changes.
docs/superpowers/specs/2026-09-03-project-pins-split-view-design.md	The written spec, agreed before implementation
todo.html.bak-pinsplit	Backup of the file as it stood before this work

Commits (on main)

- 10f9059 — spec
- 97ad895 — spec clarifications after self-review
- 6d16480 — pins, pinned-only filter, split task pane
- 561cc04 — select from anywhere on the row, and add tasks inline

Open / next

- Not yet deployed to **todo.shift-group.co** — run `vercel deploy --prod --yes` from `D:\vscode\todo` when you want it live for the team.
- Pins are per user by design, so nothing appears for Therese until she pins her own.
- Per-user ordering inside the Pinned group remains deliberately unbuilt.